

easy to view. So, if you want to show only a particular window, then you don't have to submit the full screen desktop. Instead, use the rectangular selection tool, isolate the requisite part and then submit the image. It's a very easy process and helps others to recognise what you want to show.

I have included some raw images to help you teach things easily by using the same image snippet I used. For rectangular isolating, grab the 'Rectangle Raw.png' image from the CD and open it in the Gimp. Our aim is to isolate the PTS window from the screenshot and make it look good as well.

After opening the image in the Gimp, grab the rectangular selection tool from the toolbox or press R. Create a rough selection as shown in Figure 1. Make sure that the Rounded corners option is enabled from the Tools option menu of the Rectangle selection. Now zoom in to erase minor selection defects and to gain the perfect isolation. As you can see, in Figure 1, the selection is bulging outside the requisite area. To make it perfect and professional-looking, we will remove the entire background except for the main window.

To make things look sleek, we can either reduce the selection or increase it, if the selection is deformed. The rectangular and ellipse selection tools provide editing corners from which you can manoeuvre the selection according to your needs. Just point the mouse to where the selection is deformed. You can then drag (increase/decrease) the selection by holding down the left mouse button and moving it up, down, left or right. If you don't have much control over the mouse, use the arrow keys to get precise results. Continue doing so for every part of the square, i.e., the PTS window.

Once you have a perfect selection, navigate to Edit → Copy. Then create a new template File → New. Notice that the Gimp automatically provides the resolution of the image that you are working on. So don't tinker with the



Figure 1: Rectangle Selection



Figure 2: Lasso tool in action

resolution, just create the template. Paste the selected portion using Edit → Paste. In our layer assignment (published in the August 2009 issue of LFY) we learnt about the transition of layers that are pasted. Currently, the pasted layer is in floating transition, and from here we have to decide the transition we want to set. Since we have opted to edit in a new template, we can shift the floating transition to a permanent new layer. To make your pasted image a permanent layer, simply select the Floating transition layer from the Layer Box and click on the Create a new layer icon. After that, the image pasted will be designated a new layer.

Notice that the whole image is bigger than the pasted part, so in order to create the image in the size of

the pasted part, we need to crop the undesired area. To do this, simply right-click on the newly pasted layer and select Alpha to Selection. Now navigate to Image → Crop to Selection and notice that the image is being cropped.

That's it! We have successfully isolated a rectangular portion. But if you save the image now, you will get a square cornered image. We had initially isolated using the Rounded Corner option; thus to save the image with rounded corners, just disable the Background layer by clicking on the eye and save it. If you want to add more pleasing effects, give a shadow to the image. Right click the pasted layer and select Alpha to Selection. Open the drop shadow wizard from Filters → Light and Shadow → Drop Shadow with values as 0, 30 and 100